

Disambiguating “The Three Rights” Across the Trilogy

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This work derives from and formalizes commitments across the CKS theory trilogy: “The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model” (Li, April 2026), “Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems” (Li, April 2026), and “Inter-Self Coordination via Shared Substrate / Full Aspect Integration” (Li, April 2026).

Abstract

The Coordination Knowledge Substrate (CKS) trilogy names three governance rights — to inspect, to modify, and to override substrate content and orchestration rules — as the structural expression of human governance authority over the substrate. These rights appear in all three papers but at different scopes: one governance authority over one substrate (Paper 1), tiered authority within one organizational entity (Paper 2), and joint authority over a shared substrate alongside preserved home authority (Paper 3). Paper 3 also introduces the exit right at the relationship level, which has no Paper 1 or Paper 2 equivalent. This note disambiguates these usages by establishing that the three rights are unconditional at every scope — they cannot be suspended by technical conditions, operational urgency, or system state in any paper — and that Paper 3 extends the rights to new scopes without weakening them. The central Paper 3 clarification is that “the three rights” must be qualified as *joint* (over shared substrate) or *home* (over home substrate) when operating at inter-Self scope; both sets are active simultaneously during a Full Aspect Integration event, and the exit right extends the unconditional override principle to the relationship level.

1. Concept identification

Terms in scope: *inspect right, modify right, override right, three rights, exit right*

Status across the trilogy: The three rights are established in Paper 1 as the structural expression of the human-governed commitment and carry forward without weakening through Papers 2 and 3. Paper 2 applies them at every tier of the governance hierarchy within one organizational entity. Paper 3 applies them at two simultaneous scopes during inter-Self coordination — each participating Self's home substrate (unchanged from Papers 1 and 2) and the shared substrate that spans the participating Selves' governance perimeters (held jointly) — and introduces the exit right as the relationship-level analog of the override right.

The ambiguity to be resolved: The phrase “the three rights” used without qualification refers to the Paper 1 baseline: inspect, modify, and override, all unconditional. At Paper 3 scope, “the three rights” requires a scope qualifier — *joint three rights* for the shared substrate or *home three rights* for the home substrate. Unqualified use at Paper 3 scope is genuinely ambiguous between these two referents, and that ambiguity is what this note closes.

2. Paper 1 usage: unconditional; one authority; one substrate

Paper 1 Claim 3 establishes the three rights as the structural expression of human governance authority over the substrate. Each right has a precise definition that the subsequent papers inherit without modification.

Inspect right: Governance can read any substrate content and any orchestration rule at any time without restriction or justification. No scheduling, workflow approval, or LLM intermediation can gate this access. The right is temporal as well as substantive: it is exercisable when the human decides to exercise it, not when a workflow or system state permits it.

Modify right: Governance can change any authored substrate content through a governance process, with changes versioned under authorization records. The right extends to orchestration rules as well as coordination content. The requirement of a governance process is a coordination shape, not a condition: it specifies how the right is exercised, not whether it is available.

Override right: Governance can remove or replace any substrate content without justification. This is the strongest expression of governance authority. No technical system state, operational urgency, LLM operation, or vendor policy can suspend it. A system in which override access can be prevented by any technical condition does not satisfy the Paper 1 human-governed commitment, regardless of how rarely that prevention would occur in practice.

All three rights are unconditional at Paper 1 scope. At this scope, one governance authority holds all three rights over one cell's substrate. There is one scope object, one authority structure, and no multi-authority coordination requirement.

3. Paper 2 usage: unconditional; tiered within one organizational entity

Paper 2 applies the three rights at each tier of the governance hierarchy within one organizational entity. Governance at the cell tier holds the three rights over cell-scope substrate content and orchestration rules. Governance at the aspect tier holds the three rights over aspect-scope content, including the rules that govern cell behavior within that aspect. Governance at the Self tier holds the three rights over Self-scope content, including the governance specifications authored at the aspect tier.

The tiering adds a structural dimension that Paper 1 does not have: higher-tier governance holds the three rights over lower-tier governance specifications. Self-level governance can inspect, modify, and override the aspect-level governance configurations; aspect-level governance can inspect, modify, and override cell-level orchestration rules. This recursive application is not a weakening of the rights — it is the same unconditional rights applied consistently across the

governance structure.

The rights remain unconditional at Paper 2 scope. Tiering raises the coordination cost of exercising the rights at lower levels, because doing so requires the right actor operating at the right tier. Increased coordination cost, however, is not the same as conditionality. A tiered authority structure has more organizational coordination cost than a single-authority structure; it does not have rights that can be suspended by technical state or system condition. This distinction is what the authority-not-labor principle from Paper 1 carries into Paper 2: authority is the availability of the right; labor is the cost of exercising it.

4. Paper 3 usage: home rights preserved; joint rights over shared substrate; exit right at relationship scope

Paper 3 introduces inter-Self coordination via a shared substrate. This creates two simultaneous governance scopes during a Full Aspect Integration (FAI) event: each participating Self's home substrate and the shared substrate that spans their perimeters.

Home three rights (preserved, undiminished)

Each participating Self's governance retains full, unconditional three rights over its own home substrate content throughout the FAI event. FAI participation does not transfer the three rights over home substrate content to the joint authority structure. Home governance can inspect its own home substrate content at any time, modify it through its own governance process, and override any content in it without justification — identically to how those rights operate in Papers 1 and 2. The shared substrate is a separate scope object; its existence and the FAI event's operation do not touch the home three rights.

This is the critical Paper 3 clarification for home authority: the home three rights are not diluted, shared, or held in abeyance during FAI. The architecture is explicit that each Self retains full authority within its own home perimeter, and the inter-Self perimeter wraps around both home perimeters without absorbing them. Only content that is formally part of the shared substrate is subject to joint authority; home substrate content remains under exclusive home authority.

Joint three rights over shared substrate

All participating Selves' governance jointly hold the three rights over the shared substrate's content. Joint inspect means all participating governance can read shared substrate content. Joint modify means amendments to shared substrate content require joint authorization — a higher coordination cost than single-authority modification, but not a conditional right. Joint override means joint governance can remove or replace shared substrate content through the joint amendment process.

The joint framing does not weaken the rights; it changes the authority structure required to exercise them. The coordination cost of joint authorization is higher than single-authority authorization, just as tiered coordination cost in Paper 2 is higher than single-cell cost in Paper 1. In neither case does increased coordination cost make the rights conditional on technical state or operational urgency. The rights are available as architectural properties of the joint authority structure, not as permissions that the shared substrate's technical state can grant or withhold.

Exit right (Paper 3 only)

Paper 3 introduces the exit right as the relationship-level analog of the override right. The override right (Paper 1) removes or replaces substrate content without justification; the exit right terminates the FAI relationship itself without justification. Governance holding the exit right can withdraw from the inter-Self coordination event entirely — dissolving its participation in the shared substrate — without needing to satisfy any condition arising from the FAI event's operational state or the joint authority structure's preferences.

The exit right expresses the same unconditional governance authority principle the override right expresses, at the scope of the inter-Self relationship rather than the scope of substrate content. Home governance sovereignty cannot be overridden by the FAI event; the exit right is the architectural mechanism that enforces this protection. Like the three rights at every scope, the exit right is unconditional: no shared substrate state, no operational obligation arising from the FAI event, and no joint governance decision can suspend it.

The exit right has no Paper 1 or Paper 2 equivalent because Papers 1 and 2 do not involve an inter-Self relationship that can be terminated. It is Paper 3's extension of the governance vocabulary to a scope the prior papers do not reach.

5. The disambiguation

The table below captures the scope-qualified meanings that resolve the ambiguity:

Term	Paper	Substrate scope	Authority structure	Unconditional?
Three rights	P1	One cell's substrate	Single authority	Yes
Three rights	P2	Tiered within one Self	Tiered; higher tiers over lower	Yes
Home three rights	P3	Each Self's home substrate	Each Self's own governance exclusively	Yes; undiminished by FAI
Joint three rights	P3	Shared substrate	All participating governance, jointly	Yes; joint authorization for modify is coordination shape, not condition
Exit right	P3	FAI relationship itself	Each Self's own governance	Yes; no FAI event state can suspend it

The disambiguation claim: Whenever “the three rights” appears in the trilogy without qualification, the Paper 1 baseline applies — unconditional, single authority, one substrate. At Paper 3 scope, the three rights must be qualified as home or joint. Both sets are active simultaneously during FAI. The exit right is not a qualified version of the three rights; it is an additional governance right at the relationship level that Paper 3 introduces specifically to address inter-Self scope. A reader who

encounters “the three rights” in Paper 3 context and does not see a qualifier should understand the Paper 3 distinction to apply: the note is likely addressing the shared substrate (joint) or the home substrate (home), and both are in play simultaneously.

6. Prior-art disambiguation claim

The three rights throughout the trilogy refer to the same structural governance authority expression — inspect, modify, override — extended to progressively larger and more complex scopes without ever weakening the unconditional character that defines them. Paper 2 adds tiering and recursive application across three governance levels; Paper 3 adds joint exercise over a shared scope object while fully preserving the three rights at each home scope. The exit right extends the override principle to the inter-Self relationship level, completing the governance vocabulary at every scope the trilogy addresses.

The unconditional property is the load-bearing constant across all three papers and all five rights formulations. Conditioning any of the rights — at any scope — on technical state, LLM capability, operational urgency, or any other runtime condition would break the human-governed commitment on which the entire trilogy is built. The disambiguation confirms that no paper does this: the rights are available as architectural properties at every scope, exercisable at the human's chosen time, not dependent on what any technical system can or cannot do at the moment of exercise. Increased coordination cost at larger scopes (tiering in Paper 2, joint authorization in Paper 3) does not change this: cost is a property of how a right is exercised; unconditionality is a property of whether it is available. The trilogy holds these distinct throughout.